

Michael E. Stiso

Oslo, Norway

982.30.496

mikestiso.com

mikestiso@gmail.com

linkedin.com/in/mikestiso



By training, I'm a cognitive psychologist. By practice, I'm both an applied researcher and a UXer.

I tend to focus on decision-support tools for professionals working in complex, high-stakes environments, but I have worked on many kinds of products.

SUMMARY

Cognitive psychology Ph.D.

My graduate training was in human mental capabilities and limitations, with a focus on learning and decision making. It continues to shape how I approach both research and design.

Research + design

My experience has been primarily in small teams, letting me perform both user research and interface design. Research shapes what gets designed; design raises new research questions.

Expert-user focus

The thread connecting my work is a passion for building decision-support tools for professionals in dynamic environments where choices carry real consequences, and I have pursued both in research labs and in commercial settings.

Adaptable across domains

Over 20 years working in areas such as crisis management, aviation, agriculture, banking, telecommunications, the military, energy, and enterprise solutions. While the domain changes, the underlying design problems are often the same.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UX Lead & Product Designer

2023 – Present

4Subsea

Asker, Norway

Sole UX practitioner for a digital solutions platform serving the offshore energy sector, covering everything from individual components to the structure of the whole platform.

- Adopted and refined the company's first design system (shared components, patterns, and documentation), bringing consistency across products.
- Led a platform-level usability redesign: auditing products and improving navigation models, information hierarchy, and data-display conventions.
- Expanded user research across product teams, making research a shared practice rather than a siloed function.

UX Lead

2019 – 2023

DNV

Høvik, Norway

Multiple roles across a large professional-services organization undergoing digital transformation: UX evangelism, innovation strategy, cognitive-psychology-based data visualization, and research and design across teams and products.

Experience Designer

2016 – 2019

Yara International

Oslo, Norway

Research and design for precision-farming tools across augmented reality (HoloLens), mobile, web, and chatbots. Helped develop an experience-design strategy aligning user needs with business goals.

Innovation Experimentation Lead

2015 – 2016

Nordea

Oslo, Norway

Designed fast-and-frugal experiments to assess new financial-product concepts. Qualitative and quantitative research, UX consulting, and engagement with the Scandinavian startup ecosystem.

HCI Researcher

2008 – 2015

SINTEF ICT

Oslo, Norway

Established a “decision support in complex environments” research area. Led two EU-funded crisis-management projects and the successful bid for SINTEF's role in the EU SESAR air-traffic-management programme.

Senior Usability Engineer

2005 – 2008

Oracle

Redwood Shores, CA, USA

Iterative usability testing on enterprise software, and interaction widgets of my own design: two patented, one adopted organization-wide.

Human-Systems Engineer

2003 – 2005

CHI Systems

Orlando, FL, USA

Military training and decision-support systems. Cognitive task analyses of military specialists.

INTERNSHIPS

Human-factors placements during graduate school: usability testing and expert evaluations, from a battleship ordnance console to websites, phones, and voice-response systems, with prototyped redesigns that tested better than the originals. Also studied how crews planning unmanned aerial vehicle flights make decisions.

Naval Research Intern

*Space and Naval Warfare
Systems Command*

2002 / San Diego, CA, USA

Human-Factors Intern

*SBC Laboratories
(telecommunications)*

2000 / Austin, TX, USA

Human-Factors Intern

*Air Force Office of
Scientific Research*

1998, San Antonio, TX, USA

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy

Cognitive Psychology

Texas A&M University
College Station, TX

August 2003

Master of Science

Cognitive Psychology

University of Oregon
Eugene, OR

Bachelor of Arts

Psychology

Minors: *English, Anthropology*

Purdue University
West Lafayette, IN

AWARDS

**NASA Graduate Student
Researchers Fellowship**

Marshall Space Flight Center
August 2002 – August 2003

**Air Force Office of Scientific
Research Graduate Fellowship**

Brooks Air Force Base
June 1998 – August 1998
